

INDIA CAPS DREAM RUN WITH THRILLING FINAL WIN IN BARBADOS

RAHUL DRAVID'S MEN HELD THEIR NERVE TO WIN INDIA'S SECOND T20 WORLD CUP, **HERALDING A NEW ERA** AS ROHIT SHARMA AND VIRAT KOHLI'S RETIREMENTS PAVE THE WAY FOR A YOUNG BRIGADE IN THE 20-OVER FORMAT.

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A haunting image from 2007 captures captain Rahul Dravid sitting dejected after Sri Lanka defeated India by 69 runs in Port of Spain, Trinidad. The Indian cricket team had just faced one of its most disappointing days, exiting the ODI World Cup after failing to chase a modest target on a seemingly harmless pitch.

Fast forward 17 years, and on his final day as India's head coach, Dravid leapt out of his chair as Anrich Nortje hit Hardik Pandya (right) for a single to deep midwicket. South Africa needed 30 off 30 balls with six wickets in hand to win its maiden World Cup title, but Dravid's India fought back to end an 11-year wait for an ICC title. India

was the world champion again.

India captain Rohit Sharma accepted the trophy he first won as a rookie player way back in 2007. In many ways, he forged this white-ball team in his image. Having won his first ICC trophy as captain, Rohit announced his retirement from T20Is. Moments earlier, Virat Kohli had ended his T20 international career, breaking the news shortly after receiving the Player of the Match award for his 59-ball 76 in India's seven-run victory.

Their retirements, following the T20 World Cup win in Bridgetown, represent a poignant and poetic full

